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Nairobi

Nairobi is the political, as well as financial and media capital of [Kenya](#). A city of 4.8 million inhabitants (as of 2024), it's the largest and fastest growing city in the country and one of Africa's largest cities. Nairobi is at the Nairobi River, and at an altitude of 1,795 m (5,889 ft) above sea level, making it one of the highest national capitals in the world. While a transit point that most travellers to Kenya will pass through, it's certainly also worth taking a few days to experience this bustling metropolis.

Understand

History

The word Nairobi is derived from a water hole known in Maasai as Enkare Nyorobi, which means "cool waters". Nairobi, which had been a swamp area, was founded in 1899 as a railway camp for the Uganda Railway. By 1905, the city had become the capital of Kenya (then the [British East Africa Protectorate](#)), supplanting [Mombasa](#) and [Machakos](#), the previous capitals. With the spread of plagues in the early 1900s, the town was burnt down and had to be rebuilt. Having a railway helped it to grow rapidly, becoming the second largest city in Kenya behind Mombasa. Nairobi also grew due to administration and tourism businesses (mostly big game hunting).



Colours of Nairobi

The British presence led to the creation of big hotels primarily for the British hunters. After independence, some descendants of the British settlers remained in Nairobi and obtained Kenyan citizenship, and today form Kenya's white community. Nairobi also has an East Indian community, who are the descendants of the labourers who built the railway and the merchants who set up shop during colonial times. After independence, Nairobi airport became the principal entrance point to Kenya and it still is today, although it has lost some of its importance to Mombasa.

Climate

Nairobi has a subtropical highland climate. At 1,795 metres above sea level, evenings may be cool, especially in the June/July season, when the temperature can drop to 9 °C.

Nairobi											
Climate chart (explanation)											
J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D

The sunniest and warmest part of the year is from December to March, when temperatures average in the mid-twenties Celsius during the day. The mean maximum temperature for this period is 24 °C.

Tourist information

There does not seem to be a physical general tourist office in Nairobi. The Kenyan Tourist Board's website [Magical Kenya \(https://magicalkenya.com/\)](https://magicalkenya.com/) has information about the capital too.

Get in

For general information about visas and vaccinations, etc., see the [Kenya](#) article.

By plane

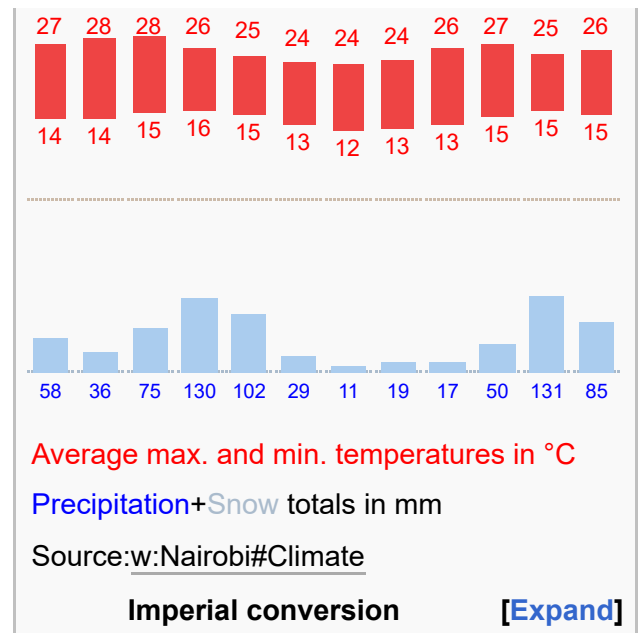
- **1 JKIA Jomo Kenyatta International Airport (<https://www.kaa.go.ke>) (NBO ^{IATA})** (is 15 km (9.3 mi) south-east from the centre of the city). Nairobi's main airport, and one of Africa's largest hubs. Terminal 1A section is linked to Terminal 1B and 1C by walkways both airside and landside. Terminal 1A has a small food court upstairs airside, and there is a Nairobi Java House between the two terminals airside. Terminal 1B is completed since renovations in 2022 and it serves departures. Terminal 1C has very little except for 10 small shops all selling the same souvenirs. Terminal 1A has a two small shops with a better selection of duty-free and souvenirs. There are Ecobank & Cooperative bank & I&M no withdrawal fee ATMs at the airport or at the cargo terminal. (updated Dec 2022 |)

Airlines

[Kenya Airways \(http://www.kenya-airways.com\)](http://www.kenya-airways.com) (KQ) is the national airline of Kenya, and used to be one of the largest and most reputable airlines in Africa, connections from as far as [New York JFK](#) (a direct 15-hr flight), a couple of major European and Asian airports and the largest African airports. As of 2025 the airport is also served by major African, Middle Eastern and European airlines, China Southern and Indigo.

Transfers

- If taking a **taxi** from JKIA, use a reputable taxi. Many are waiting outside to give you conveyance, and the cost should be very near Ksh 2,000 to the city centre; Westlands or places more west or north will be more. There is an official KAA taxi desk just after you exit the customs area, where you can buy a fixed-price voucher, and they will escort you to a taxi. When taking a taxi to your accommodation, do not be inveigled into taking their recommendation for accommodation. **Uber or Bolt** costs from Ksh 900 from airport to the centre.
- **Airport Bus:** To the city centre, Airport Bus #34 for Ksh 100 (as of 2023). You get the bus by walking on the road from the international airport terminal to the cargo terminal, or from in front of the Ambassador Hotel on Moi Avenue in the city centre. 6:00-20:00. The bus trip can take 2 hours in bad traffic, and may be inconvenient if you have big luggage.



Wilson Airport

- **2 Wilson Airport (WIL ^{IATA})**. 11 km (7 mi) south from the city's centre, handles mainly domestic flights (and international flights to nearby destinations including Entebbe, Kilimanjaro and Zanzibar) and general aviation.

There is no official taxi desk at Wilson, and each airline operates out of its own terminal. It may be difficult to arrange a reputable taxi on arrival, but there are plenty at the kerb.

By train

Nairobi has become much more accessible by rail. **Kenya Railways** (<http://krc.co.ke>) has opened the **SGR** railway in 2017 linking Nairobi and Mombasa, reducing travel time between the two cities to 5/6 hours. There are both express, night and slower intercity services, the latter stopping on more intermediate stations, all services are named Madaraka Express. Tickets cost Ksh 1000 for 2nd class and Ksh 3,000 for 1st. The difference between the first and 2nd class is just the size of seats. As the train is very popular it is recommended to buy tickets a few days beforehand. Trains operating on the SGR line call at **Nairobi Terminus**, which is almost 10 km southeast of city centre. A connecting commuter train to the central station is available. there are now 3x trains a day from Nairobi to Mombasa 1x is a night train.



The Nairobi Terminus station, well outside the city centre

As of June 2023 there is 2x weekly train service from Nairobi from Nanyuki via Nyeri. The train departs Nairobi old central railway station at 09:30 every Tuesday and Friday and takes six hours. The fare is Ksh 200 in 3rd class and Ksh 1000 in 1st class. there is also 1x weekly train from Nairobi to Kisumu every Friday which cost ksh 600/2000 and takes 12 hours.

- **3 Nairobi Terminus** (Syokimau railway station) (*10 km southwest of city centre*). Connected to the central station by commuter rail, see get around by train below for information about getting between those two. (updated Nov 2020 |)
- **4 Nairobi central railway station**. Central railway station and hub for Nairobi commuter trains services. (updated Nov 2020 |)

By bus

Nairobi is the centre of Kenya's (mostly reliable) bus system. There are many bus companies operating to and from the country's different cities.

- Mombasa Use the SGR railway, it take less than half the time of the bus and costs 50% less.
- Arusha in Tanzania 5½ hr by **Modern Coast**. Arusha Shuttle (<http://www.arushashuttle.com/>).
- Kisumu, Eldoret, Kitale, Kericho by **Easy coach** (<https://easycoachkenya.com>).
- Kampala 12 hr by **Modern coast**, **Dreamline** or **Mash Poa**.

By matatu

Matatus (11- to 18-seater minibuses) and shuttles (6-seater cars) are convenient, inexpensive (and often the only) modes of public transport for connecting Nairobi with towns and tourist destinations in the Rift Valley and Central Highlands such as Naivasha, Nyeri, Nanyuki, Isiolo, and Thika. Matatus can be obtained from the River Road area. Extreme caution should be exercised in this area because petty theft is a major concern; avoid showing valuables such as mobile phones, even while in the matatu (see safety section below). The best method of connecting to a matatu is to arrange for a taxi to drop you off and pick you up directly at the location of the matatu that you are boarding or alighting from. If you're boarding a matatu from Nairobi, tell the taxi driver your destination and they will drop you off at the correct location. If you are being picked up, then tell the taxi driver the location you're coming from as well as the matatu company that you are using (your ticket should have the operator's name). It is best to arrange for a taxi from the hotel you're staying at. The price is dependent on the distance of travel.

- from/to Naivasha (Ksh 300) 1½ hr
- from/to Nanyuki (Ksh 700) 11 seat. 3 hr

Companies

- **Prestige Shuttle**, Dubois Road, has 10-seat vans going from Nairobi to and from Nakuru and Kisumu. Ksh 600/1200.
- **North Rift Shuttle** behind the Afya Centre has 10-seat vans going from Nairobi to and from Eldoret. from Ksh 900.
- **Impala shuttle** (<https://www.impalashuttles.com>) Parkside hotel, 25 Monrovia Street, next to Jeevanjee Gardens.

By boat

Entry into Nairobi by boat is not possible (Nairobi River is not navigable), however one could certainly arrive in Kenya by boat via Mombasa or Lamu, proceeding by road, air or rail to Nairobi. Immigration should be processed at the port facility.

Get around

Be careful getting around Nairobi. Traffic is very bad like any other major city, but if you use common sense and a local or guide you should be able to get where you want.

By car

Hiring a car is convenient as it allows you the freedom to explore Nairobi at your own pace. Most rental companies in Nairobi offer self-drive and chauffeured options respectively. You will find that a large fleet of cars available for hire are Japanese: Toyota, Nissan or Mitsubishi. You can hire both automatic and manual transmission. All rental cars are right-hand drive. Hiring a vehicle with a driver or chauffeur is advisable due to the generally lower standards of driving, average to poor road conditions and the overall cost effectiveness of not having to pay a deposit on hiring a vehicle which is the case with a self drive vehicle.

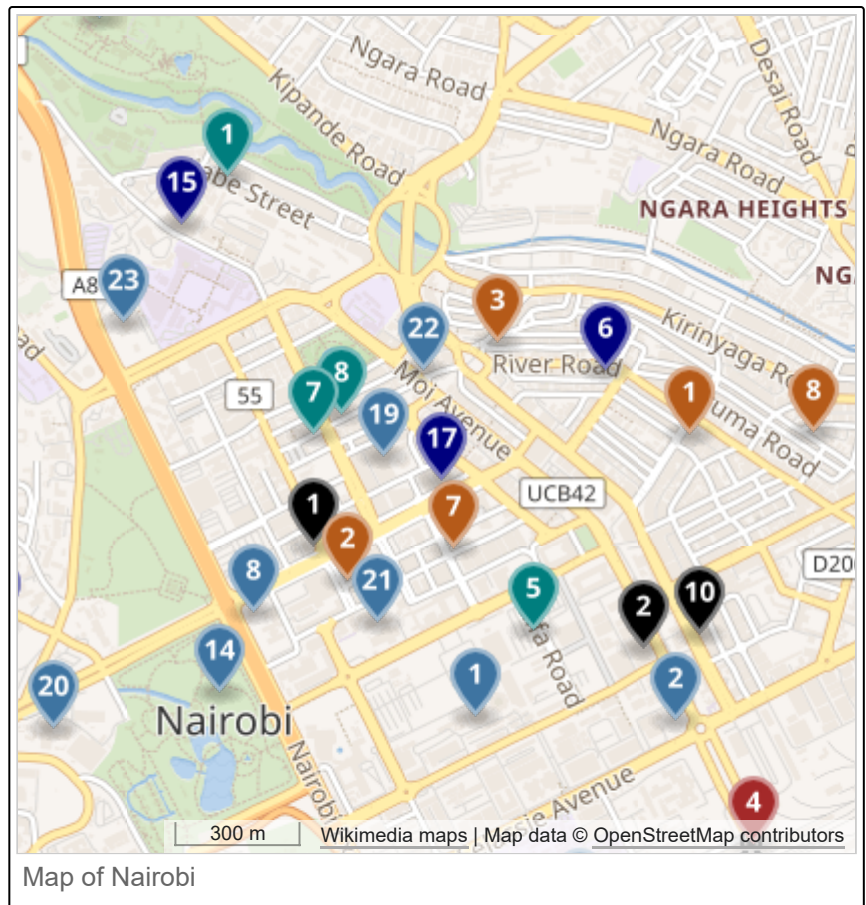
The car rental rates are often determined by the number of days and estimated mileage per day. Some car hire companies will give you a rate that is 50% cheaper but either give you a contract with a clause limiting you to visit the specific locations, an old car or require a hefty deposit. The rates are cheaper if you are hiring the car for a week, a month or are looking for a lease. Most car rental rates include unlimited mileage, PSV comprehensive insurance, theft and damage waivers.

The driver and fuel are charged separately with some companies requiring that you hire a driver if you are taking a large 4X4/4WD (e.g. a Toyota Prado, Land Cruiser j70, Range Rover, Land Cruiser VX, Land Rover discovery).

Although a good number of local car hire companies are reliable, you should either take photos of the car before the hire, or carefully note the dents or scratches on the car and agree. In addition, carefully read the rental contract to check for rules on insurance liabilities in case of accident or theft of the vehicle.

Here are some reliable car hire companies in Kenya:

- **Nairobi Car Hire** (<http://gorillasafarisrwnda.com>) offer good services for 4x4 and other categories of cars.
- **Central Car Hire** (<http://www.carhirekenya.com>) are a reliable, trustworthy and helpful rental company based in Nairobi. Two-wheel drive and four-wheel drive vehicles are available and are well maintained.
- **Nairobi Car Hire Services** (<http://www.hireddrive.com/kenya-car-hire/nairobi/>) provided by Hire N' Drive Kenya Limited who are very flexible with their rental terms and reliable. They accept credit card payment online with a very credible refund processing system. They also have a wide fleet of cars available at all major airports in Nairobi, Mombasa, Kisumu, Nakuru and Eldoret.
- **Elite Car Rental Kenya** (<http://www.elitecarrentalkenya.com>) although their offices are located in Kikuyu Town, they are a reliable car rental company and have been in operation since the mid-1990s.
- **Avis Rental** (<https://www.avis.co.ke/>) the local representative of the global business. Services are dependable with a variety of self drive vehicle options.
- **Hertz Car Hire** (<https://www.carrentals.com/car-company/hertz-car-rentals-nairobi-airport-nbo.v-tla/>) are also represented in Kenya and offer pick up and drop off at the international



Road by the University of Nairobi



airport in Nairobi.

- **Explorer Kenya Safaris** (<https://www.explorerkenya.com/safari-vehicle-hire-kenya/>), Garden Estate Road. Victory House. 3rd Floor. Apartment 1, ☎ +254 722218260, info@explorerkenya.com (<mailto:info@explorerkenya.com>). Offering safari 4x4 Land Cruisers and safari vans for use in Nairobi and on safari (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **Ravina Tours & Travels Ltd** (<https://ravinatoursandtravels.com/packages/>), Mombasa Road. Vision Plaza. 3rd Floor. Apartment 2, ☎ +254 722103340, info@ravinatoursandtravels.com (<mailto:info@ravinatoursandtravels.com>). Offering safari 4x4 Land Cruisers and tour vans for use in Nairobi and on safari in all parks in Kenya. (updated Dec 2025 |)

For ease of navigation around town and to the outskirts, it is advisable to use Google Maps. The navigation guide can be combined with other useful apps such as to help you get a better experience. For ease of search and navigation to secure parking lots, you can use **Pata Parking**, a smartphone app which is downloadable from Google Play Store and Apple's App Store. The app enables drivers to search and pre-book for parking, with details of location, charges per hour, features of the preferred parking lot, and the number of reservable parking spaces.

Car hire from the airport is possible, and fairly painless with prices in line with other African countries. Travelling during the day reduces your chances of getting car-jacked as most car-jackings occur after dark, but even so, carjacking can still happen at any time of day, even with a strong police presence. However, watch out for undisciplined drivers, as they take little regard for safety.

By taxi

Taxis are neither very cheap nor prevalent. Prices should always be negotiated before the trip, and paid afterwards (only cash is accepted, often with limited change available). This can be tricky as it requires you to be knowledgeable on the market rate price of the ride you wish to take. Typically, taxis can be found parked around hotels, malls, and tourist areas. The taxis tend to be marked with a yellow line on each side. Your best bet is to ask a local or enquire at your hotel.

The taxi services (<https://www.nairobiarushashuttles.com/>) Uber (<https://www.uber.com/en-GB/cities/mombasa>), Bolt (formerly Taxify) (<https://bolt.eu/cities/nairobi/>), Little (<https://little.bz/>), and MaraMoja (<https://www.facebook.com/maramojatransport/>) have become the hired car provider of choice among Nairobi's large expatriate population due to its convenience, cost competitiveness, and higher quality of service when compared to other taxi providers.

If you want a pre-arranged taxi with consistent pricing, you can try Davina Cabs (<https://davinacabs.com/>). They have cab service in Mombasa, Nairobi, Kisumu and have an office in Eldoret.

By bus (matatu)

Matatus (public minibuses/commuter buses) are generally used for travelling between downtown Nairobi (<https://www.nairobiarushashuttlebus.com>) and the suburbs. Matatus vary in size, between the van sized 14-seat matatus and the larger 50-seat buses (<https://impala-shuttles.com>). While generally safe, matatus are involved in a high number of accidents every year. Matatus are often overcrowded with more people than seatbelts and therefore can be dangerous if involved in accidents. Because there are no licensing requirements, matatus are often poorly

driven, with drivers passing on curbs, speeding, or passing in oncoming lanes while cars are oncoming. On each bus is a conductor who will hang out of the matatu and call out a price (usually Ksh 50-100 as of 2020) and location the matatu is driving. The government banned the 14-seat matatus inside Nairobi to reduce traffic and accidents in town. The best choice is probably the City Hoppa bus service, the revived Kenya Bus Service and the newly introduced electric buses (2025). Beware of traffic jams on the major highways, not only in the rush hours.

By train

- There is a commuter rail service from the Central Nairobi Railway Station going to Syokimau Railway Station, also known as Nairobi Terminus. Syokimau Railway station is where you take trains going to Mombasa (see Get in by train above).
- Train departures from the downtown Nairobi railway station going to Syokimau are at 6:35, 8AM, 9:35, noon, 17:30 and 18:20. From Syokimau the train departures are 6:20, 7:15, 8:50, 14:30 and 20:20. The trip takes 30 minutes. A one-way ticket costs Ksh 50-100 (as of 2023).
- There are four rail commuter lines in Nairobi:
 - 1.Nairobi main station from Kahawa which departs Nairobi at 8AM, and from Kahawa back to Nairobi at 9AM.
 - 2.Nairobi main station from Embakasi Village Station. It departs Nairobi station at 7:20, 9:30, 11:20, 13:30, 18:00 and 18:30 from Embakasi village station back to Nairobi station departs at 7:00, 8:00, 10:15, 12:10, 14:20 and 19:15.
 - 3.Nairobi main station to Kikuyu station.
 - 4.Nairobi main station to Syokimau station.

By foot

Walking around Nairobi is fairly easy since the city is small and places are easy to get to. However, there are some areas within the city where tourists should not go, and walking around at night should be minimised. Thugs are rampant in many areas. The city centre may be considered safe by some to venture on foot, but it can't be considered a pleasant experience. Expect to be approached by beggars, touts, etc.



Green Nairobi



By cycle

Cycling is quite uncommon in the city and most roads are not at all suited for safe cycling. With that said, there are a few protected cycle lanes within the central district and the government are keen to expand them into a small network.

See

Nairobi is known as the safari capital of Africa; however, the city has still managed to keep up with modernization. Unlike other cities, Nairobi is surrounded by 113 km² (70 mi²) of plains, cliffs and forest that makes up the city's Nairobi National Park. The city is filled with many things to do during the day and the night. Tourists can have their pick from numerous safaris (wildlife,

cultural, sport, adventure, scenic and specialist), ecotourism tours, restaurants, culture, shopping and entertainment. While in Nairobi, tourists can also engage in numerous sports from golf, rugby, athletics, polo, horse-racing, cricket and football (soccer).

- **1 Kenyatta International Conference Centre (KICC) (Central District)**. The best place to get that far ranging view over the sprawling, congested metropolis that is Nairobi. You can go up to the saucer-shaped top of the conference centre's round viewing tower and depending on smog and fog, you might be able to see as far as the slums and the national park. Ksh 400, Ksh 200 reduced. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **2 August 7 Memorial Park (<http://memorialparkkenya.org>)** (US Embassy Bombings Memorial Site) (Central District). In 1998 a truck bomb blast rocked downtown Nairobi. The US Embassy building had been the target of a terrorist attack, reducing it to rubble and killing 213 people, mostly bystanders, and leaving more than 4,000 injured. On the same day, the US embassy in Dar es Salaam was also subject to a similar attack which killed 11 people and injured 85. 21 people were charged, including Osama Bin Laden. The former embassy site today contains a memorial park, with a monument engraved with the names of every victim. Ksh 30. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **3 Westlands by night**. Visit the bustling and hip Westlands district, which has turned into the new nightlife centre of Nairobi. Many restaurants and bars line the busy Woodvale Grove and Mpaka Road. A visit to 'Tree house' club is a must if you are looking for a spacious one and crowd outnumbered with expats, rather than the otherwise congested natives dominated ones. Traffic can become hectic, well into the early hours. Security is generally tight and the action spills out from packed clubs into the street. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **4 UN Office at Nairobi (<https://kenya.un.org/en/about/about-the-un>)** (UN Complex Gigiri), United Nations Ave, ☎ +254 20 762 2034, un.tours@un.org (mailto:un.tours@un.org). Sitting between the Karura Forest and the US Embassy, it houses international organisations such as the UN Environmental Programme, UN-HABITAT and is the basis of all UN operations in Africa. Africa's first completely carbon- and water-neutral building was opened here in 2011. Guided tours allow tourists to see the major buildings and gifts from member states and walk along a nearby nature trail, while learning about the history and work of the UN. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **5 Nairobi Mamba Village (<https://mambavillagecentre.co.ke/>)**, The Mamba Village, Langata N Rd, ☎ +254 714782653. 09:00-18:00 daily. Kind of an adventure-tourism park with Nile crocodile feedings, tortoise holding, ostrich viewing, horse/dromedary rides, and boat rides. One croc feeding takes place on Sundays at 16:30. Also a restaurant on site. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Museums

- **6 Nairobi National Museum (<http://www.museum.s.or.ke/>)**, Museum Hill, ☎ +254 20 3742131. 8:30AM-5:30PM. Where visitors can learn about Nairobi, its history and culture. The museum was founded in 1910. Adults: Kenyan citizens Ksh 200, East African residents Ksh 600, non-residents Ksh 1200. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **7 National Railway Museum (<https://facebook.com/nrailwaymuseum/>)** (southwest of Haile Selassie Ave and Uhuhu Hwy roundabout), ☎ +254 0721 268741, info@krc.co.ke (mailto:info@krc.co.ke). Daily 8AM-5PM (including holidays). Visitors can learn more about the history of Kenya's railways and the Kenya/Uganda railway. It also houses some of the engines and rolling stock from the



Nairobi National Museum



country's colonial period. Adults: Kenyan citizens Ksh 200, East African residents Ksh 500, non-residents Ksh 600. (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **8 Nairobi Gallery** (<http://www.museums.or.ke/nairobi-gallery/>), P.O. Box 40658-00100, ☎ +254 20 216566. This is a museum housing only special exhibits, so the featured artwork is always changing. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **9 Karen Blixen Museum** (<http://www.museums.or.ke/karen-blixen/>), P.O. Box 40658-00100, ☎ +254 20 8002139. Of interest if you have read Karen Blixen's book *Out of Africa* or the movie. Her house is now the home of the museum. You have to be accompanied by a guide to visit the house, but you can walk around the gardens on your own. If you're not into the movie, and don't know the history of the house, then it may not be worth your while taking the hour or so it takes, and the price of admission. The house has little remaining original furnishings, but there are some of the props used in the movie here (although the movie wasn't filmed here - it was create on a set). It is on the outskirts of Nairobi (in the suburbs of Karen) and a taxi or bus can get you to the museum. It's not too far from the Elephant Orphanage and the Giraffe Centre, so these attractions can easily be combined in a single trip. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **10 Bomas of Kenya** (<https://bomasofkenya.go.ke/>), Langata/Forest Edge Road, ☎ +254 20 891391. Portrays Kenya's culture. Visitors can see exhibits of traditional Kenyan homes, artifacts, dances, music, and song. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Parks

- **11 Nairobi National Park** (*just outside Nairobi*). This is home to large herds of zebra, wildebeest, buffalo, giraffe, lion, cheetah, hippo, and birdlife (over 400 species). Here you can also go on the Nairobi Safari Walk, an educational centre to make people aware of wildlife and habitat conservation. Also in the park is the Nairobi Animal Orphanage. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **12 Sheldrick Elephant Orphanage** (<http://www.sheldrickwildlifetrust.org/>) (*close to the Nairobi National Park*), ☎ +254 736 919321. 11:00. They take in orphaned elephants from all over Kenya, and keep them until they are able to survive in the wild. Visiting hours are daily at 11:00, so you should aim to arrive about 10 minutes before that time. You will be admitted and the elephants will be fed in two groups for around an hour. After than there is a brief time to shop and look around, and it closes again around 12:30. If you are willing to sponsor an elephant for US\$50, you can make an appointment to see your elephant put to bed at around 17:00. These brief visiting times are to ensure that the elephants are not overly exposed to humans. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **13 Giraffe Centre** (<https://www.giraffecentre.org/>) (*in Lang'ata, about 20 km from Nairobi CBD*). The centre breeds the endangered Rothschild giraffe and has conservation/education programmes for Kenyan children. It also has many warthogs and leopard tortoise. You'll receive food to feed the giraffes, and get close enough to touch them. Just outside/opposite of the centre is a (free) nature hiking trail which is popular among residents. In August 2021 the centre was undergoing renovations but remained open, though with limited access to the giraffes. Ksh 1500/750 for non-resident adults/children. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **14 Uhuru Park**. Spacious park in the city centre. Attractions include a monument, playground, boat rental. free. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **15 Uhuru Gardens** (<https://sportsheritage.go.ke/uhuru-gardens/>), Langata Road. Built in remembrance of the struggle for independence, which Kenya was granted in 1963. The monument is a 24-m (79 ft) high triumphal column supporting a pair of clasped hands and the dove of peace, high over a statue of freedom fighter raising the flag. The monument is surrounded by fountains and lush-landscaped gardens. Not to be confused with "Uhuru Park" (which is in the city centre). As of August 2024 the park was closed and undergoing construction. (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **16 Arboretum Park.** Very nice park to walk and to relax from the hectic town. Because of entrance fee you will not be molested by beggars, sellers, etc. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **17 Karura Forest.** has an area of 1 063 ha, making it largest of three main gazetted forests in Nairobi (the others are Ngong Forest and Ololua Forest). One of the best forest parks to walk, run, ride, picnic relatively close to the city. It is safe, well marked and a very nice place to relax and enjoy nature. The River Cafe is a good place to rest. Bicycle rental for Ksh 500/2 hours. (Single use) plastic are not allowed. Usually quiet on weekdays but gets very busy on weekends (Sunday). Attractions include a small waterfall and some monkeys. Ksh 600 for non-residents. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **18 City Park (<http://www.jambonairobi.co.ke/activities/picnic/nairobi-city-park/>).** The city park is a good place to spend leisure time without any disturbance within an indigenous forest and with lots of sykes monkeys. They are trustful and come close due to being fed by visitors frequently. As they expect food from the visitors they get moody if you have nothing. On weekends and national holidays the park becomes very lively. There are some nature trails, but not really safe for foreign tourists. Another highlight of the City Park is the vegetables and fruits market in one corner of the park near Lumuru Road. Avoid going into the forest when it is dark. It is not safe. The park is not a must go destination, but worth to visit if you have extra time. Entry to the park is free. (updated Dec 2025 |)



City view from Uhuru Park



Karura Forest Nairobi



Religious sites

- **19 Jamia Mosque (<https://www.facebook.com/JamiaMosqueNairobi>)** (*Central District*). While Jamia Mosque is tucked away in between other buildings there are striking views to be glimpsed of its intricate structure from many different angles. Easily the most impressive religious structure in the capital, the interior is off-limits to non believers (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **20 All Saints' Cathedral.** Cathedral of the Anglican Church of Kenya, built in 1924. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **21 Cathedral Basilica of the Holy Family.** Striking modernist Catholic Church Cathedral designed in 1960. The Basilica is the seat of the Archdiocese of Nairobi. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **22 Khoja Mosque.** Built in a Victorian architecture style in 1922 by the Isma'ilism community led by Aga Khan. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **23 Nairobi Synagogue (<https://www.nairobisynagogue.org>).** The only functioning synagogue in East Africa. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Around Nairobi

- **24 Ol Donyo Sabuk National Park (<https://www.kws.go.ke/ol-donyo-sabuk-national-park>)** (*65 km from Nairobi*). Centred on a 2,146m (7,141 ft) mountain, this is mountain forests and plains, with a large population of Buffalo. It also serves as a refuge for Colobus monkeys, bushbuck, duiker, leopard, and a large variety of bird species. Another attraction is to climb the **Kilimambogo mountain**. A good starting point is the Ol Donyo Sapuk Resort (<http://oldonyosapukresort.co.ke/>) where you can find a guide too. It is a 9-km hike to the top of

the 2,145m-high mountain which takes about 3 hours with pit-stops at the observation area with a scenic 180-degree view as well as Macmillan's burial site. (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **25 Tana River** (*An hour's drive from the city*). White water rafting throughout cataracts, which leads to the 14 falls, can be done here. The rafting trip also includes a full BBQ lunch. (updated Dec 2025 |)
 - **26 Kiambethu Tea Farm, Limuru** (<http://www.kiambethufarm.com/>), ☎ +254 729 290894. 11:00-14:30. A beautiful tea farm, about 40 minutes away from the city centre of Nairobi. The farm house is set within beautiful gardens surrounded by acres of tea and indigenous forest - home to the colobus monkey and plenty of other wildlife. (updated Dec 2025 |)
 - **27 14 Falls at Thika**. 14 Falls are 55 km from Nairobi, close to the Ol Donyo Sabuk National Park, near the town of Thika, one of the biggest suppliers of pineapples in Kenya. You will see the expansive plantations on your way to the falls. 14 small streams merge to form the big waterfall at the foot of the Kilima Mbogo Hills. These streams are part of the Athi River. At first glance the falls are magnificent; however, the river is strongly polluted by industrial waste and a foul chemical smell and reams of rubbish strewn across all the rocks really ruin the experience. At Thika are the Thika and **Chania Falls** close to the Blue Post Hotel (<http://www.blueposthotel.co.ke/>). That's interesting too for a stop to or from the 14 falls. Also worth a visit are the **Mau-Mau caves** in which allegedly Mau Mau fighters hid during the independence battles between Thika and Mangu, about 6 km from Thika Entrance fees for 14 Falls are: US\$15 per person, US\$5 parking, US\$5 per camera. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- 
- Fourteen Falls
- 
- **28 Kitangela Glass** (<https://www.kitengela.glass/>). In this imaginative place, beautiful art objects are made of recycled glass and exhibited in a lovely garden. In a shop different types of glassware are on sale. Guided presentations take place every 30 min. (updated Dec 2025 |)
 - **29 Kereita Forest zip line** (<http://theforest.co.ke>). 8AM-6PM. At the Kereita Forest near Kiambu along the Nairobi-Nakuru highway is East-Africa's longest zip line tour, offering over 2.4km of flight across the lush. (updated Dec 2025 |)
 - **30 The Anti-Gravity Hill (Kituluni Hill)** (*After a hairpin turn on the road 12 km outside of Machakos town on the ascent to the Kituluni Hills, about 60 km southeast of Nairobi.*). One of the strangest natural phenomena along the Kenyan Rift Valley is the point that the native Kamba mysteriously call "anti-gravity." Young men gesticulate on the street to demonstrate the "miracle" to visitors for a small fee. They put a plastic bottle filled with water on the asphalt, which apparently rolls uphill. If you ask them if they gave the bottle a nudge, they empty the contents onto the street. The water flows slowly uphill – apparently. Those blindly taking a few steps would swear they are going downhill. But the way undoubtedly goes up. (updated Dec 2025 |)
 - **31 Swara Plains Conservancy**. Swara Plains is a fenced sanctuary where zebras, giraffes, ostriches, monkeys and many other "non raptor" animals can be observed. Here you can go for a walk or ride a bike something that is almost everywhere prohibited in the national parks but is fun for children. (updated Dec 2025 |)
 - **32 Olorgesailie pre-historic site** (<https://museums.or.ke/olorgesailie/>) (*along Magadi road, 70 km away from Nairobi*). World renown as "world's largest stone-tool factory". Part of the Smithsonian Human Origins global locations. The site has camping spots and nice bandas-huts for rent, as well shower and WC facilities. If you're up for it, you can hike Mt Olorgesailie, but it's an all day event. (updated Dec 2025 |)
 - **33 Lake Magadi** (https://pages.mtu.edu/~alguth/Magadi_Project/The_Magadi_Project.html). Salt lake with hot springs for SPA, soda ash and salt production and many flamingos (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **34 Hells Gate National Park (<https://hellsgatepark.org/>)**. A nice alternative to the more traditional Safari. Given the absence of dangerous animals, it is possible to visit this park on foot or by bike. The landscapes are very impressive, especially the descent into the canyon. All with the presence of different animals, zebras, wildebeests, buffaloes, warthogs, and several endemic species of birds and insects. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Do

Art and shopping

- **1 Go-Down Arts Centre (*South of Centre*)**, ☎ [+254 20 555770](tel:+25420555770). A former warehouse turned arts centre - this has also happened in Nairobi and this spot allows you to get a glimpse of what contemporary Kenyan artists are up to, including exhibitions, performances and discussions.
- **2 Kazuri Beads shop**. Started in 1977 the workshop of beads is adjacent to Karen Blixen's Museum. It was started by an English woman to provide sustainable income to poor Kenyan women. Has beautiful jewellery created of clay brought from the areas surrounding Mt. Kenya.
- **3 Village Market**. Visit Village Market and Sherlocks.



Central park



Food and drink

- **Try excellent food**. Nairobi has a great variety of international food. For more information see the [Eat](#) section.
- **Nightlife**. Go dancing and be a part of Nairobi's excellent nightlife. For more information see the [Drink](#)-section.

Local life

- **4 Oloo's Children Center (OCC) (*Kibera*)**, ☎ [+1 616 987-1106](tel:+16169871106). Lend a hand at the volunteer-operated school, take a tour of Kibera, and have a cup of tea with the OCC Founder. The founder of the school lives in Kibera and works to provide children in need with education and meals.

Sports and physical activities

- **Ice-skating**. Go ice-skating at Panari.
- The **5 Ngong Racecourse** - Horse flat-racing takes place three Sundays a month, and is a great way to spend an afternoon.
- **Hiking**: there are several good hiking places near Nairobi, e.g. in the Chyulu Hills or Ngong Hills.
 - The Ngong Forest Reserve is 25 km south west of Nairobi. It is a popular walking and picnicking venue. In Ngong is a station where you have to pay the park entry fee, and those who want to also for a guide. There is only one route, the walk from Ngong to

Corner Baridi (Kiserian), which takes about 4–5 hr; you hardly can get lost. Also organized hiking tours are offered.

- Other nice places for hiking are the Mount Longonot National Park and the **Menengai** Crater, a massive shield volcano with one of the biggest calderas in the world, in the Great Rift Valley, Kenya. It is the largest volcano caldera in Kenya and the second largest volcano caldera in Africa

Safari

Nairobi is the capital of safaris in Kenya. There are tour operators from budget to world class all over the city. Yet it is not easy find the best fitting. For important things to consider when booking see Kenya#Safaris.

Buy

Money

Most transactions are cash only, so it is best to have enough cash on hand to pay for purchases and transport. Cash is dispensed in units of Ksh 1,000. Many smaller businesses will not have much change, so before going shopping for curios be sure to have a good selection of smaller notes. On the other hand many stores will accept international credit cards. All big supermarket chains accept credit cards without a surcharge.



The Maasai Market



Exchange bureaux are found in many parts of the city where tourists are common. They will exchange cash of different currencies, and may also accept a personal cheque for Kenyan cash. They will want a photocopy of your passport before they exchange money. Rates are not bad, but will be worse than a banking machine will offer. Many exchange bureaux and hotels will *not* accept or exchange American currency printed before 2000. When the exchange bureaux do accept pre-2000 notes, they typically offer substantially lower exchange rates than for currency printed after 2000. Exchange rates are also typically lower for small denomination currency than for US\$100 and \$50 bills.

There are **ATMs** in major shopping areas of Nairobi and in the airport. Ecobank. Cooperative Bank, Gt Bank, NCBA, Sidian bank, DTB, I&M charges no fees for withdrawals (e.g. by Visa or Mastercard) through their ATMs. Absa and Standard Chartered Bank, Stanbic, Equity, BOA, KCB have a minimum Ksh 400-700 ATM fee for overseas cards at all their ATMs. Eco Bank (<http://www.ecobank.com>) has ATMs in 36 African countries.

Another option for payment is the **M-Pesa** (<https://www.safaricom.co.ke/personal/m-pesa>) app. It is a mobile phone-based platform used for most money transactions in Kenya. M-Pesa agents are available all over Kenya. You can use the platform instead of carrying cash around for safety purposes.

This may also be a good place to repeat the warning about safety. Pickpockets are rampant in Nairobi and have been known to keep an eye on people getting cash from a machine. It is best to carry cash in a hidden pouch rather than a wallet. Men should not carry their wallets in their back pockets, and women should not carry their purses to the side or behind them, particularly in busy locations.

Maasai Market

For local curios and souvenirs, the most easily accessible and tourist-friendly is the **Maasai Market** (<https://www.facebook.com/MaasaiMarketNairobi/>). Prepare to haggle and as a guide, pay about half to two-thirds of the asking price. It takes place Tuesday-Sunday on different places around the city according to the following schedule (as of 2024):

- Tuesday: **1 Kijabe Street** opposite the Norfolk Hotel - for slightly better prices. This market is less secure, but is larger and offers more variety and opportunity for bargaining.
- Wednesday: **2 Capital Centre** on Mombasa Road near the airport
- Thursday: **3 Junction Shopping Mall** on Ngong Road
- Friday: **4 Village Market** in Gigiri - an upmarket, open concept shopping centre near the United Nations and American Embassy complexes. Bargaining is necessary, and one should probably not spend more than Ksh 1,000 on one item, except in extraordinary circumstances.
- Saturday: **5 The High Court parking lot** in the centre
- Sunday: **6 Yaya Centre** in Hurlingham

Biashara Street

- **7 Biashara Street**, downtown, is the spot for textiles. Make sure you pick up at least one *kikoi* or *kikoy* (a traditional wrap for Swahili men, predominantly at the coast).
- **8 Haria's Stamp Shop** (<http://www.hariastamp.com/>), ☎ +254 731 868 246, +254 706 868 246, hariastamp@gmail.com (<mailto:hariastamp@gmail.com>). 8:30-18:00. One of the best selections of kikoy and other African fabrics and souvenirs. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Shopping malls

- **9 Two Rivers Mall** (<https://tworivers.co.ke/>), off the northern bypass road, ☎ +254-722-205339. Daily 09:00-21:00. The largest mall in east and central Africa. Has a Carrefour Hypermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **10 Garden City Mall** (<https://www.shopgardencitymall.com/>), Thika Super highway. Daily 09:30-21:00. Many stores including a Carrefour hypermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **11 The Sarit Centre Mall** (<http://www.saritcentre.com/>), Westlands. Daily 08:00-21:00. Many stores and a small cinema, and a Carrefour hypermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **12 Westgate Shopping Mall** (<http://www.westgate.co.ke>), 15 Mwanzi Road, ☎ +254 715-557775. Daily 08:00-24:00. Possibly more internationally famous than other malls, though for the wrong reasons: it was the target of a terrorist attack in 2013. Has a Carrefour Hypermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **13 Southfield Mall** (<http://www.southfieldmall.co.ke>), Airport North Road, ☎ +254 739-774477. Daily 08:00-22:00. Has a Carrefour Hypermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **14 The Village Market Mall** (<http://villagemarket-kenya.com>), Limuru Road, ☎ +254 20-7122488. Mall open daily 07:00-23:00, store hours vary. It has a Carrefour Market. (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **15 Thika Road Mall** (<http://www.trm.co.ke>), T R M Drive, ☎ +254-700-876876. Daily 08:00-22:00. Many stores and has a Carrefour hypermarket (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **16 The Hub Karen Mall** (<https://www.thehubkaren.com/>), Dagoretti Road, ☎ +254-702-120120. Daily 09:00-21:00. Many stores. The anchor tenant is a Carrefour hypermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **17 The Junction Mall** (<https://www.facebook.com/thejunctionmallkenya>), Ngong Road, ☎ +254-20-3872881. Daily 06:00-23:00. Many stores and a Carrefour hypermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **18 Yaya Centre Mall** (<http://www.yaya-centre.co.ke>), Argwings Kodhok Road Hurlingham, ☎ +254-709-439000. Daily 09:00-20:00. Many stores and a Chandarana Food Plus supermarket. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Supermarket

- **Jaza Retail** (<https://shop.jaza.ke/>), Oi Donyo Sabuk road Nairobi. The first hard discount supermarket chain in Kenya with 9 stores in Nairobi. (updated Jul 2024 |)

Eat

Nairobi has a wide range of Indian restaurants that speaks to the significant South Asian community in Kenya. The city also offers other restaurants specializing in different European and Asian cuisine. Restaurants serving international cuisines can be found in downtown and in the areas of Westlands, Hurlingham, Kilimiani, and Lavington. Among the many cuisines available are Italian, Brazilian, Chinese, Thai, Japanese, German and French restaurants.



Food at a hotel

In addition, there are several local restaurants that cater to local cuisine like sukuma wiki (green spinach-like vegetable, 'Kale' in English), ugali (corn bread, ground maize flour and made to a tasty white bread/porridge form), nyama choma (literally: meat roast), chapati and other specialities.

There are also many of the internationally well-known fast-food chains in the city and they are also very popular with the Kenyan youth.

Budget

- **1 Hot dishes** (<http://www.hotdishes.co.ke/>) (5 restaurants around Nairobi). A chain restaurant serving local food. Several venues in Nairobi CBD. Spacious with ample seating, reasonably clean. Mains Ksh 180-450 ksh. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **2 KK Restaurant**, Koinange Street and Standard Street (in CBD of Nairobi), ☎ +254 718210110. 06:00-19:00. A downtown eatery well-known for featuring economical African fare such as beef stew with managu, goat meat, grilled tilapia, porridge, maize, njahi, minji, kienyeji, etc, plus breakfasts. Sometimes service can be a bit slow, but it is a well-liked place. (updated Dec 2025 |)

This page uses the following price ranges for a typical meal *for one*, including soft drink:

Budget	Under Ksh 500
Mid-range	Ksh 500 - Ksh 1400
Splurge	Over Ksh 1400

- **3 Roast House**, Ngariama Lane. In the city centre facing the matatu station on Tom Mboya Rd. Regular local prices with more selection, excellent food, friendly service. Very busy at lunchtime. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **4 Habesha** (<https://habesharestaurant.co.ke/>), Arwings Kodek Road. daily 9AM-11PM. Near Yaya centre- great Ethiopian food for around USD5-6, although they serve Nescafé coffee rather than the traditional Ethiopian freshly-roasted beans. around Ksh 1000. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **5 Red Sea**, Mbono Road. An authentic Eritrean restaurant located on the top floor of **China Centre** on Ngong Road near the Chinese embassy. Meals cost around Ksh 500 and the food is excellent, with nice traditional coffee ceremony. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Mid-range

Nairobi has a fantastic array of mid-range eateries.

- **6 Abyssinia Exotic Ethiopian Restaurant** (<http://www.abyssiniarestaurantnairobi.com>), Muguga Green, Off Brookside Grove, Off Waiyaki Way, ☎ +254 725 3515 1515. An Ethiopian restaurant with delicious food. Mains from Ksh 500-800. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **Java House** (<https://javahouseafrica.com/>). With quite a few locations, including The Junction, ABC Place, and close to the United Nations, features a western coffee house menu, from bagels to burritos, with excellent coffees and milkshakes, and a full breakfast menu. Another popular coffee house is Dormans. Ksh 500-750 for a complete meal.. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **7 Trattoria**, Town house, Kaunda Street. An Italian restaurant. Do not expect anything decent when it comes to the mains (all around Ksh 700). However, there is a fabulous and extensive dessert menu, including crepes, tiramisu, souffle, and a coffee granita with fresh cream (Ksh 250-500). (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **8 Motherland**, Charles Rubia Road. An authentic Ethiopian restaurant with great and affordable food (typical of Ethiopian restaurants in Nairobi!) (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **9 Havana Bar** (<https://m.facebook.com/HavanaBarNairobi/>), Woodvale Grove, Westlands, ☎ +254 20 445-0653. Popular bar and restaurant with a laid-back Latin theme. Renowned for their sizzling fajitas, steaks and seafood dishes. The kitchen is open daily from noon until late. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **10 Village Market Food Court**. Has an array of different ethnic cuisines, including Thai, Italian, Chinese and German, as well as a Mongolian Barbecue. Good prices as well. Venture further into Village Market to find a good Japanese restaurant as well, though with slightly steeper prices. There are also food courts at other malls in the city. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Splurge

- **11 The Carnivore**, Langata Link Road. Just outside the city, close to the Uhuru Gardens along Lang'Ata road, it is a luxury restaurant famous for its meats. Once seated, different masai grilled meats will be carried around on sticks and carved to your plate at request. Very expensive by Kenyan standards, beware of additional taxes and catering levies. Reservations might be a good idea, ask at your hotel. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **12 Furusato** (<https://furusatorestaurant.com/>), Ring Rd Parklands. Located in Westlands, has fantastic Japanese food. For a price. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **13 The Lord Errol** (<https://www.lord-erroll.com/>), 89 Ruaka Road. Past Village Market and into Runda, is said to have very good food, and is popular with the expat crowd. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **14 Palacina Bistro**, Kitale Lane. On State House Hill at the Palacina Hotel, a very upmarket bistro fusion grill restaurant in a lovely outdoor setting. Fantastic food. (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **15 Alan Bobbe's Bistro**, Rhapta Road (*at Andrew's apartments, at the end of Rhapta road near St. Mary's School*). A venerable, legendary restaurant now located on Rhapta Road (near St. Marys School). Founded in 1962, the restaurant features French haute-cuisine at about a third of what you would pay in Paris! (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **16 Le Palanka Pan**, 46 Gitanga Road. Many Kenyan dishes, but also many dishes from other African countries (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **17 Seven Seafood & Grill** (<https://www.experienceseven.com/>), ABC Place (*ABC Place Waiyaki Way*), ☎ +254 737 776677. 24. Amazing seafood and spectacular decor a must visit. Ksh 2000. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Drink

- **1 New Florida Clubs (F1)**, Kenyatta Avenue/Koinage Street. The New Florida, locally known as Madhouse or Madi, is in the heart of Nairobi on Koinange Street. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **2 Pango (F3):**, Harambee Avenue, ☎ +254 20 229-036, info@floridaclubskenya.com (<mailto:info@floridaclubskenya.com>). Commerce House, 1st Floor. The latest addition to the Florida Group. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **3 Shooters & Dips Cocktail Lounge** (<http://www.panarihotels.com>), Mombasa Road (*Panari Sky Centre, Mombasa Road opp Simba Colt Offices, 5km from JKIA*), ☎ +254 787 637948. Daily from 17:00. Handpicked music by the DJ. The bar offers a varied food menu along with a long list of signature cocktails, fine wines and liquors. Ksh 250. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **4 Mercury Lounge ABC**, ABC Place (*Off Waiyaki Way*), ☎ +254 722 309947. Daily 16:00-late. An upmarket modern cocktail and tapas bar. A delicious tapas and bitings menu, and the best cocktails and high end spirits array in Nairobi. All major imported and local wine and beers are available chilled to perfection. A popular hangout for expats, well to do locals and local business leaders. Ample parking and good security make this one of Nairobi's more popular spots. Shooters and cocktails range US\$3-6 with shooters and high end, globally popular wines and spirits USD6-15. All major credit cards accepted.. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **5 Klub House 1 (K1)** (<https://www.kahamagroup.com/k1klubhouse>), Ojijo Road (*is located along Ojijo Road in Parklands*), ☎ +254 20 374 9870, info@klubhouse.co.ke (<mailto:info@klubhouse.co.ke>). Live music, cocktails. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **6 Choices Lounge and Restaurant**, Karen Road, ☎ +254 72 648 5228, mmuchami@yahoo.com (<mailto:mmuchami@yahoo.com>). Great place to watch Formula 1. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **7 Black Diamond (Mradi)**. Many expats and travellers and has a cover band that plays very good music. A lot of ladies of the night here, always after the expats. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **8 Havana:**, 33 Woodvale Grove, ☎ +254 795 984345. It's an expats' favourite on Thursdays nights. The live band on Saturdays attracts a good cosmopolitan crowd. Bar snacks available throughout the night. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **9 Cockpit**. Langata Road not just popular with Wilson Airport pilots (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **10 Club LA** (<https://www.facebook.com/pages/Club-LA/1809975822600055>), Tom Mboya Street. 8PM -till late. One of the nice dance club & night clubs in Nairobi. A beer from Ksh 200. Soft drink from Ksh 150. has a Facebook page. best nights are Friday and Saturday. No fee to go in. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **11 Santuri Salon Spotlight Sessions** (<https://santuri.org/Santuri-Salon>), Ring Road Parklands (*The Mall (basement level) in Westlands*). monthly event for upcoming East



Karen Blixen House



Sleep

Budget

The area around Tom Mboya Street & River Road has a lot of low cost hotels. Budget accommodation in Nairobi is from Ksh 1000 for a single room.

This guide uses the following price ranges for a standard *double* room:

Budget	less than Ksh 3000
Mid-range	Ksh 3000-6000
Splurge	more than Ksh 6000

- **1 Milimani Backpackers & Safari Centre** (<http://www.milimanibackpackers.com>), Oldeani Crescent, ☎ +254 718 919 020. It has internet, WiFi, hot showers, and bar. They offer dorms, doubles, singles, twins, camping space, permanent tents, and cabins. Milimani also offers safaris and other trips. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **2 Manyatta Backpackers**, Milimani Road, ☎ +254 722 466 765. Six-person dorm. hot water showers. free wifi. This backpackers is near downtown Nairobi. 20 min walk. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **3 Destiny Hotel**, Duruma Road (*downtown Nairobi*), ☎ +254 20 2253 1236. Check-in: 10am, check-out: 10AM. Single room with own hot water bathroom. nice clean good value for money hotel. great place for backpackers and travelers. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **4 Jungle Junction campground**, Karen Kongoni Road. (*near Ngiri road.*), ☎ +254 722-752865. Check-in: noon, check-out: noon. Camping, dorm beds, room with own bathroom. Warm showers, fast internet, good kitchen, laundry service. Also kitchen for cooking own food available as well as common room. Workshop for overland vehicles on site. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **5 Mad Vervet Backpackers Hostel**, 55 Chalbi Dive House number A3 (*4.2 miles from the centre*), ☎ +254 718 340 134. Check-in: noon, check-out: noon. 4/6 bed dorm, double room shared lounge tv area, laundry, shared kitchen, garden, safety deposit box, bar,. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **6 Inks hotel**, Latema Junction River Road CBD, ☎ +254 707 353 937, info@inshotel.com (<mailto:info@inshotel.com>). Check-in: 11:00, check-out: 10:00. Single/double room with own hotwater bathroom. 24-hour front desk, bar, free wifi, flat screen TV, safe box. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **7 Hotel Africana**, Dubois Rd, ☎ +254 757 916 555. Check-out: 10:00. Simple rooms with hot water bathroom. free WiFi. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Mid-range

- **8 Olive Gardens Hotel** (<http://www.theolivegardens.com>), Argwings Kodhek Rd, Hurlingham (*Opposite Nairobi Women's Hospital*), ☎ +254 20 2737854, +254 20 2727777. 62 rooms. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **9 Ole-Sereni Hotel** (<http://www.sarovarhotels.com>) (Sarovar Hotels & Resorts), Mombasa Rd (*5 km from Jomo Kenyatta international airport off Mombasa Rd opposite Zain offices*), ☎ +254 20 390 1000, geetika@sarovarhotels.com (<mailto:geetika@sarovarhotels.com>). Check-in: 12:00, check-out: 12:00. Wildlife resort overlooking the Nairobi National Game Park. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **10 Savannah Sands Executive Apartments**. (<http://savannahsands.co.ke>), Off Ngong Road (*behind Nairobi Baptist Church*), ☎ +254 20 2710116. Features furnished and serviced apartments, as well as unfurnished and unserviced apartments. (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **11 DusitD2 (<http://d2nairobi.com/>)**, 14 Riverside Drive, Riverside Woods (*north west of city, near University of Nairobi Chiromo campus*), ☎ +254 204233000. This is a stylish 4-star hotel. Thai restaurant on site, outdoor pool, gated secure compound. (updated Dec 2025 |)

Splurge

- **12 Fairview Hotel Nairobi, Vignette Collection by IHG (<https://www.ihg.com/vignettecollection/hotels/us/en/nairobi/nbofn/hoteldetail>)** (Fairview Inn), Bishop Road, ☎ +254 722 204429. Also on upper hill, the Fairview is a lovely old historic hotel, with beautiful grounds and several restaurants. It is quiet at night, a real respite from the city. They also rent apartments. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **13 Southern Sun Mayfair Nairobi (<https://www.tso.gosun.com/southern-sun-mayfair-nairobi>)** (former Holiday Inn), Parklands Rd, ☎ +254 20 3688000. Built in the 1940s as the Mayfair Court Hotel, this historic hotel has retained its charm even as it joined the Holiday Inn family. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **14 Nairobi Serena Hotel (<https://www.serenahotels.com/serenanairobi/en/default.html>)**, Kenyatta Ave, ☎ +254 20 2822000, nairobi@serena.co.ke (mailto:nairobi@serena.co.ke). In the middle of Nairobi's Central Park, this hotel offers a quiet place to stay. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **15 Fairmont The Norfolk Hotel (<https://www.fairmont.com/norfolk-hotel-nairobi/>)**, Harry Thuku Road, ☎ + 254 20 2265000. 30 min from the airport, and a short distance from the shopping district. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **16 Safari Park Hotel & Casino (<https://www.safaripark-hotel.com/>)**, Thika Rd, ☎ +254 020 3633000, reservations@safariparkhotel.co.ke (mailto:reservations@safariparkhotel.co.ke). Started as a retreat for British Army officers during colonial times, this hotel is 15 min from downtown. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **17 Sarova Stanley (<https://www.sarovahotels.com/stanley-nairobi/>)** (The Stanley Hotel), Kenyatta Avenue / Kimathi Street, ☎ +254 719 048000. This over 100-year-old hotel has been renovated back to its Victorian style. In the city's shopping and business district. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **18 Windsor Golf Hotel & Country Club (<https://www.windsorgolfresort.com/>)**, Kigwa Ln, ☎ +254 20 864 7000, reservations@windsor.co.ke (mailto:reservations@windsor.co.ke). 15 min from the city centre, 45 min from the airport. There is an 18-hole golf course on site. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **19 The King Post (<https://thekingpost.co.ke/>)**, Rhapta Road, Westlands, ☎ +254 734 261 182. The King Post brings about a unique architectural synthesis between the East African coast and the lands across the Indian Ocean. It reflects the social and cultural interaction between the regions over more than 2000 years. Accommodation is in 1-, 2- or 3- bedroom apartments available on daily basis and long-term. The apartments are secluded but not isolated from the hustle and bustle of the city centre and the main roads being surrounded by peace, tranquility and security. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **20 Giraffe Manor (<https://www.thesafaricollection.com/properties/giraffe-manor/>)**, Gogo Falls Road, ☎ +254 111 033 900. The converted home of the founders of the African Fund for Endangered Wildlife is a few kilometres from the city centre. It sits on 57 ha (140 acres) of land. The giraffes can be fed at the front door or even from the second floor bedroom window! (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **21 Ngong House (<http://www.ngonghouse.com>)**, 114 Ndovu Road, ☎ +254 20 2513331. 30-min drive from the city centre and airport, the Ngong House is on a land that used to be



Nairobi's night skyline



part of a vast coffee estate. On the grounds are five traditional looking, yet elegantly decorated tree houses. (updated Dec 2025 |)

- **22 Sankara Hotel** (<http://www.sankara.com/>), 5 Woodvale Grove, Nairobi, Kenia, ☎ +254 70 302 8000. Also a nice place for just a sundowner or cocktail at the pool bar on the 7th floor with great views and chic ambience (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **23 Mövenpick Hotel & Residences Nairobi** (<https://www.movenpick.com/en/africa/kenya/nairobi/hotel-residences-nairobi/overview/>), Mkungu Close, Westlands, ☎ +254 709 548 000, hotel.nairobi@movenpick.com (<mailto:hotel.nairobi@movenpick.com>). Check-in: 14:00, check-out: 12:00. €148-341. (updated Dec 2025 |)
- **24 Palacina Hotel** (<https://www.palacina.com/>), State House Area, Kitale Lane, Off Dennis Pritt Road, ☎ +254 733 777 173, info@palacina.com (<mailto:info@palacina.com>). (updated Dec 2025 |)

Stay safe

Nairobi has a reputation for thievery. Beware of snatch and grab, con artists, or groups of people following you. Scams are elaborate and can involve up to 10 or more people working together. The best advice for a tourist is to stay in the city centre, know where you are at all times, and pretend you know where you're going (even if you don't). If you find yourself in an unfamiliar area your best bet is to find a taxi (although you will probably pay dearly if the driver suspects a panicked westerner!) Don't carry large quantities of money or passports on the street, and assume that anyone trying to engage you is up to no good or trying to sell you something. If you stay smart and play safe, without going around much after dark, Nairobi can be a safe place to stay. Most locals are honest people who will happily help you if you approach them. The areas where you have to take special care are: Globe Roundabout, Archives, Ambassadeur, Muthurwa Market, around Nation Centre, Landies Road, Nyamakima, Kirinyaga Road, and Uhuru.

Kenyans are proud people and there is not a lot of begging like you find in some other countries. Some opportunistic people will hang around shopping centres and beg, but they will generally accept a simple 'sorry' and leave you alone if you do not give. Many of these 'beggars' are middle-class kids or adults who have realised they can profit from exploiting white guilt, and should not be encouraged. If you are ever lucky enough to visit a slum as a local (not on some perverse tourist safari) you will discover the poorest of the poor do not even beg.

Outside of tourist and expat communities, young children will become excited at the sight of a white person and may come running towards you to try to shake your hand while yelling out 'mzungu' (white person) or 'how are you?'. Older kids are more reserved, and you should be wary of kids who are older than 9 or 10 who are trying to distract or get close to you.

Slums should be avoided by tourists as you will attract a lot of attention which can quickly turn into a dangerous situation.

Apart from the inner city centre, Nairobi dies out at night. Streets are mostly empty. Do not walk alone after nightfall. Always use taxis. The areas north and east of River Road should be avoided, especially if you're not a local!

Biashara Street is a safe shopping street due to the presence of 10-15 Maasai guards. A place to avoid as a tourist is the City Market; you could end up paying a much higher price than on Biashara Street.

If you are in a matatu and moving slowly through traffic, particularly after dark, you should keep your window closed if your valuables are in reach to prevent people snatching them from the outside (there are thieves who walk through traffic looking for such opportunities). Mobile phones and wallets should be securely kept and not displayed prominently during calls or cash transactions in the River Road area, particularly after dark.

Eastleigh (known as 'little Mogadishu') is an area near the city centre that is decaying due to years of neglect by the government (including the police). It is predominantly populated by Somalian migrants and refugees, and most Kenyans will not go there for fear of their safety. Tourists would be wise to avoid it day and night.

There have been several grenade attacks in the city for which Al-Shabaab have claimed responsibility. These are likely to be ongoing while the Kenyan army has a presence in Somalia. They are random and often fatal, and one should be wary and report any suspicious behaviour. Associated with the terrorist threat, you can expect to pass through security checkpoints with armed guards at most attractions, shopping malls and even on the streets. You can expect (at times) to have to have your bags searched, and car checked.

Stay healthy

It is recommended that before tourists come to Nairobi, that they should be vaccinated well in advance (6 weeks) of their trip. The most common recommended vaccines for people traveling to Africa are tetanus, diphtheria, polio, typhoid, hepatitis A, hepatitis B, yellow fever, rabies and meningitis.

Food and beverages

Be careful with the food that you eat outside the more upscale establishments. Before eating, make sure that the food is freshly and thoroughly cooked and served hot.

Also avoid **seafood**, except at upmarket restaurants and hotels, and make sure that your fruits and vegetables have been properly washed in clean water. The safest fruits to eat are bananas and papayas.

Do not drink **tap water** or *brush your teeth* with it. Only use bottled or canned drinks (especially popular brands). Also, do not use ice as it may also be contaminated water, and remember that alcohol does not sterilize a drink. The general rule of thumb is, the more high end an establishment is, the greater the safety of the food and drink within.

Insects

In much of Africa you are going to be exposed to yellow fever, dengue fever, other viral diseases, sleeping sickness, filariasis and malaria, although none of these diseases is a concern in Nairobi. When insects are biting you should cover up and wear long-sleeved shirts and trousers, socks and pyjamas especially when night falls. It is best to use an insect repellent that contains DEET



Skyline from Nairobi National Park



on your exposed skin and clothing. As for mosquito nets, it is best to use a permethrin-impregnated net along with an insecticide such as pyrethrum coils or an electric mosquito killer during the night. And remember to spray your hotel room every evening.

Heat and sun

Make sure to drink plenty of fluids (not coffee, alcohol or strong tea) to avoid dehydration. If you are well hydrated, your body will produce plenty of clear urine. The average temperature is around 25°C (maximum might reach 30°C) throughout the year. People coming from Asian countries like India will not have much problem with the weather — in fact it will seem pleasant year-round. For people who are from cold countries, it can take three weeks to become accustomed to the heat. Try to avoid plenty of physical exertion and to stay in the shade and keep cool as much as possible. Increase the amount of salt intake in your food and water. Also, apply a lot of high-factor sunscreen, avoid direct sunlight, and try to wear a hat and shady clothing.

Connect

There are very many internet cafés around Nairobi, but connection speeds and computers are not always super fast, but still you will manage to open your email, probably even use a webcam or watch YouTube. Prices are usually at ranges from Ksh 0.5/minute to Ksh 1/minute, usually with a minimum fee of Ksh 5-20. The more expensive internet cafés are rarely better and the best ones charge Ksh 1/minute with discounts for using the internet for longer. Most of the good cafés are found in Norwich Union which has quite a number just opposite Hilton Hotel next to Nandos while the expensive ones are found in malls in Westlands. Although it may be more appropriate for tourists to use the ones in Westlands since they are usually less crowded and are more exclusive but not necessarily faster or better in terms of equipment.

Free wireless internet is available at Java House restaurants and Doorman's coffee shops in the city and malls. Some bars like Havana in Westlands also offer free wifi. The internet cafe in Sarit Centre also has wireless internet available at a good speed and a reasonable price.

Mobile phones are ubiquitous in Kenya with fairly good coverage from all providers **Safaricom, Airtel and Telkom** that extends to most populated parts of the country. Safaricom has the best national coverage especially if you are using 4G data. The phone system is GSM 900 and 3G-4G 2100 (Asian and European standard) on Safaricom, Airtel and Telkom. Phones and SIM cards are available at many locations throughout Nairobi and the country including at the airport. Phone prices are very competitive and priced for average income Kenyans. A basic phone may be obtained new from an independent dealer for ~Ksh 2000. A vast majority of people use pre-paid phones with scratch-card top-ups available at a huge number of merchants across the country. Phones are sold "unlocked" by outlets for use on any network. Safaricom though does sell a number of phones locked to its network. Much business is conducted via mobile phone, so possession of one for even a relatively short stay in the country can be beneficial. Rates are extremely affordable with in-country calls at around Ksh 3 per minute. Overseas calls cost around Ksh 5 per minute to the United States (~USD\$0.06/minute) and Ksh 3 per minute to India on the Airtel network.

3G data service is available in most coverage areas on Safaricom and is of a fairly high standard. The other networks have 3G in major population areas and EDGE/GPRS everywhere else. If you have a smart phone you should buy a data pack (200mb, 500mb or 1.5gb) or your credit will go down very fast. Airtel and Telekom have lower prices for calls and data.

Cope

Smoking is against the law out on the streets in the city centre (the downtown grid area with numerous skyscrapers). There are certain smoking zones, and outside of the city centre it becomes much easier to find locations where it is acceptable. However, a general rule would be to not smoke along the side of any roads or streets with pedestrians and/or vehicles. Be observant and take your cues from other smokers - if there are no smokers or cigarette butts on the ground, it is likely a non-smoking location.

Embassies, Consulates and High Commissions

-  **Australia** (<http://www.kenya.highcommission.gov.au/nair/home.html>), Riverside Dr (400 m off Chiromo Rd), ☎ +254 20 4277100, fax: +254 20 4277139.
-  **1 Canada** (<https://www.international.gc.ca/country-pays/kenya/nairobi.aspx?lang=eng>), Limuru Road, Gigiri, ☎ +254 20 3663000, fax: +254 20 3663900, nairobi@international.gc.ca (<mailto:nairobi@international.gc.ca>). M-Th 7:30-16:00, F 7:30-13:00. Also provide services to Canadians in Somalia and Uganda.
-  **China** (<http://ke.china-embassy.org/eng/>), Woodlands Rd, ☎ +254 20 2726851, fax: +254 20 2726402, chinaemb_ken@mfa.gov.cn (mailto:chinaemb_ken@mfa.gov.cn).
-  **Cyprus**, International House 6th Floor, Mama Ngina St, ☎ +254 20 2220881, fax: +254 20 312202, cyprusnairobi@gmail.com (<mailto:cyprusnairobi@gmail.com>). M-F 9:00-16:30.
-  **Djibouti** (<https://www.facebook.com/pages/category/Consulate---Embassy/Djibouti-Embassy-Nairobi-1903302856420224/>), Mama Ngina St, ☎ +254 20 2122859, fax: +254 20 313120.
-  **Egypt** (http://www.mfa.gov.eg/english/embassies/Egyptian_Embassy_kenya/Pages/default.aspx), 24 Othaya Rd off Gitanga Rd, Kileleshwa, ☎ +254 20 4441248, fax: +254 20 3870383, eg.emb_nairobi@mfa.gov.eg (mailto:eg.emb_nairobi@mfa.gov.eg).
-  **Eritrea**, 2F New Rehema House, Rhapta Rd, ☎ +254 20 4441248.
-  **Ethiopia**, State House Ave, ☎ +254 20 2732054, fax: +254 20 2216044, executive@ethiopianembassy.or.ke (<mailto:executive@ethiopianembassy.or.ke>).
-  **Finland** (<http://www.finland.or.ke>), Eden Square, Block 3, 6th floor, Greenway Rd off Westlands Rd, ☎ +254 20-3750721-4, fax: +254 20-3750714, sanomat.nai@formin.fi (<mailto:sanomat.nai@formin.fi>). M-F 9AM-noon.
-  **Germany** (<http://www.nairobi.diplo.de>), 113 Riverside Drive, Ludwig Krapf House, ☎ +254 20 4262000, fax: +254 20 4262129, info@nairobi.diplo.de (<mailto:info@nairobi.diplo.de>).
-  **Greece** (<http://www.mfa.gr/nairobi>), 13F Nation Tower, Kimathi St, ☎ +254 20 340722, fax: +254 20 2216044, gremb.nai@mfa.gr (<mailto:gremb.nai@mfa.gr>).
-  **Indonesia** (<http://www.kemlu.go.id/nairobi/Pages/default.aspx>), Menengai Road, Upper Hill P.O.Box 48868, ☎ +254 20 714-196, +254 733 133 000, fax: +254 20 713-475, indonbi@arcc.or.ke (<mailto:indonbi@arcc.or.ke>).
-  **Japan** (<http://www.ke.emb-japan.go.jp/>), Mara Rd, Upper Hill, ☎ +254 20 2898000, fax: +254 20 2898220.

-  **Nigeria** (<http://www.nigeriankenya.or.ke/>), Lenana Rd, Kilimani, ☎ +254 20 3864116, fax: +254 20 3875871, ng@nigeriahighcom.org (<mailto:ng@nigeriahighcom.org>).
-  **Romania**, Eliud Mathu Street 1119, Runda, P.O. Box 63240-00619, ☎ +254 721 214073, +254 708 368303, nairobi@mae.ro (<mailto:nairobi@mae.ro>). Embassy
-  **South Korea**, 15F Anniversary Towers, University Way, ☎ +254 20 2220000.
-  **Spain**, CBA Building, 3rd floor, Mara & Ragati Road, Upper Hill, ☎ +254 20 2720222, fax: +254 20 2720226, emb.nairobi@maec.es (<mailto:emb.nairobi@maec.es>).
-  **Rwanda** (<http://kenya.embassy.gov.rw/>) (*Limuru Rd, Gigiri*), ☎ +254 20 7121321, fax: +254 20 7121324, rwanemba@wananchi.com (<mailto:rwanemba@wananchi.com>). M-Th 09:00-17:00, F 09:00-14:00.
-  **Serbia** (<http://www.embassyofserbia.or.ke/index.html>), State House Ave, ☎ +254 20 2710076, fax: +254 20 2714126, nairobi@embassyofserbia.or.ke (<mailto:nairobi@embassyofserbia.or.ke>).
-  **United Kingdom** (<http://ukinkenya.fco.gov.uk/en/>), Upper Hill Rd, ☎ +254 20 2844000, fax: +254 20 2844-088, DLNairobi-CommercialSectionprotect@fco.gov.uk (<mailto:DLNairobi-CommercialSectionprotect@fco.gov.uk>).
-  **United States** (<https://ke.usembassy.gov/>), UN Ave, ☎ +254 20 363-6000, fax: +254 20 363-3410.

Go next

- Kisumu
- Kakamega Rainforest: the last primeval rainforest in the country, and home to various monkeys and hundreds of bird species
- Lake Naivasha is worth at least a day's visit and has enough to keep you occupied for two or three days. Lakeshore country clubs are a good place for lunch. You can take a boat ride on the lake to see hippos, go for a walk among zebra and giraffes on Crescent Island, ride thoroughbred horses among zebra, giraffes and wildebeest at the Sanctuary Farm, and ride bicycles among wildlife and dramatic scenery at Hell's Gate National Park.
- Nakuru National Park, although further afield, deservedly warrants a 1-night stay for a late-afternoon and early-morning game drive.
- Maasai Mara National Reserve: Kenya's most important National Park
- Mount Longonot National Park: Daytrip to hike on a 2700m volcano
- Aberdare National Park: known for high population of rhinos
- **Ol Pejeta Conservatory** (<https://www.olpejetaconservancy.org/>) provides a sanctuary for great apes and rhinos

